

Carrying the Harvest by Hand — Supplement

Supplementary materials S1–S4 for Thomas (2026), *Carrying the Harvest by Hand: The Threshing Floor, a provenance-first, human-in-the-loop instrument for studying public Reddit discourse*. Every value below is generated from the files in the `preprint/` directory by `reproduce.sh`.

S1 Sampling frame and collection protocol

Protocol

- Before collecting**, complete the governance audit for each community (`data/protocol/governance_audit_template.csv`): archive the sidebar rules (e.g., via a web archive) and record the archive URL and a SHA-256 hash of the rules text, posting restrictions, flair or approval gating of comments, account-age or karma thresholds, visible AutoModerator activity, removal-reason disclosure, public moderation logs, moderator count, flair taxonomy, and language norms.
- Fix the parameters** for every community in a wave: keyword “Iran”, sort “top”, time window “month”, 100 posts per page. Record the wave’s start time (UTC).
- Gather page 1** by opening the URL below in a desktop browser, selecting all (Ctrl/Cmd+A), copying, and pasting into Thresh. Thresh reports the after cursor and gives the page-2 URL (template below). Pause between pages.
- Gather comments** for each post in the Harvest detail panel; for comparability, gather every thread, not a hand-picked subset, and note any threads that could not be loaded.
- Export** each community as its own collection (CSV, pseudonymized) and place the unzipped folder in `preprint/data/collections/`. Re-running `reproduce.sh` adds the community to every table and computes cross-collection pseudonym overlap automatically.

Table S1. Complete sampling frame. Page-1 URLs were generated by executing Thresh’s own URL builder (`public/js/reddit.js`); for later pages append `&after=<cursor>` as Thresh instructs. Prefix every URL with `https://www..`

Code	Community	Tier / role	Principal caveat	Page-1 URL
C1	<code>r/MiddleEast</code>	Core. Broad regional framing of the conflict	Self-selected regional audience; not representative of regional populations	<code>reddit.com/r/MiddleEast/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month</code>
C2	<code>r/geopolitics</code>	Core. Analytical/strategic register; high signal-to-noise complement to <code>r/worldnews</code>	Lower volume; analytic register selects for a particular writer	<code>reddit.com/r/geopolitics/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month</code>
C3	<code>r/politics</code>	Core. Domestic partisan framing of the war (worked exemplar in this paper)	What appears is the moderated subset; moderator orientation can shape removals	<code>reddit.com/r/politics/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month</code>
C4	<code>r/Libertarian</code>	Core. Constitutional and war-powers framing	Ideologically specific community	<code>reddit.com/r/Libertarian/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month</code>
C5	<code>r/CredibleDefense</code>	Core. Substantive military analysis under strict sourcing norms	Heavily curated; low volume; expert-leaning self-selection	<code>reddit.com/r/CredibleDefense/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month</code>
S1	<code>r/worldnews</code>	Special case. Narrative amplification and test case for coordinated-activity detection	Documented 2018 target of an Iranian influence operation; treat as methodologically distinct	<code>reddit.com/r/worldnews/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month</code>
A1	<code>r/iran</code>	Conditional anchor. Diaspora and inside-Iran voices	If political discussion is gated the sample is a curated subset not a community baseline	<code>reddit.com/r/iran/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month</code>

Code	Community	Tier / role	Principal caveat	Page-1 URL
A2	r/iranian	Conditional anchor. Second diaspora anchor; contrast with r/iran governance	Smaller community; sample size constraint	reddit.com/r/iranian/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month
R1	r/exmuslim	Secondary. Deliberately partial perspective on Iran and human rights	Reflects ex-Muslim diaspora views; never a stand-in for Iranian communities	reddit.com/r/exmuslim/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month
R2	r/persianculture	Secondary. Cultural framing with lower political volume	Speculative fit; verify scope	reddit.com/r/persianculture/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month
R3	r/tehran	Secondary. Inside-Iran perspective	Small; sample size constraint	reddit.com/r/tehran/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month
R4	r/arabs	Secondary. Framing counterpart to r/MiddleEast	Self-selection	reddit.com/r/arabs/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month
R5	r/Conservative	Secondary. Right-leaning counterpart to r/politics	If participation is gated it is not a symmetric counterpart to r/politics	reddit.com/r/Conservative/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month
R6	r/AskMiddleEast	Secondary. Question-answer register	Q&A format generates different data; needs analytic adjustment	reddit.com/r/AskMiddleEast/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month
R7	r/war	Secondary. Military-framing triangulation	Different audience from the others	reddit.com/r/war/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month
R8	r/IsraelPalestine	Secondary. Narrative analysis; site for studying coordinated communication	Heavily brigaded from multiple directions; sentiment unreliable	reddit.com/r/IsraelPalestine/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month
R9	r/syriancivilwar	Secondary. Comparison case for how Reddit discusses other regional conflicts	Different conflict; comparison only	reddit.com/r/syriancivilwar/search.json?limit=100&raw_json=1&q=Iran&restrict_sr=on&sort=top&t=month
X1	r/iranian_diaspora	Excluded. Proposed but no evidence of an active community was found	Drop unless its existence and activity are confirmed	—

S2 Tool verification report

The harness analysis/verify_tool.js executes Thresh’s production modules in a Node.js sandbox with no network access. Run 2026-09-29: 12 of 12 checks passed.

Table S2a. Harness checks.

Check	What it establishes	Result
url.politics_keyword_search	Keyword search URL for the worked example is exactly as recorded	PASS
url.multireddit_normalisation	“r/geopolitics, CredibleDefense” normalizes to Reddit’s multireddit “+” syntax	PASS
url.comments	Per-post comments URL (limit 500, raw_json)	PASS
parse.listing_ok	Synthetic listing parses to 2 posts with the correct “after” cursor	PASS
parse.comments_depth_and_more_stubs	Nested replies flatten with depths 0, 0, 1, 2; “more” stubs skipped	PASS
schema.posts_v2_equals_v1_exemplar	v2 post export columns = v1 exemplar columns (same order)	PASS
schema.comments_v2_equals_v1_exemplar	v2 comment export columns = v1 exemplar columns (same order)	PASS

Check	What it establishes	Result
csv.bom_and_quoting	CSV has UTF-8 BOM; commas, quotes, newlines escaped per RFC 4180	PASS
parse.friendly_errors	Each malformed-paste class returns a specific plain-language message	PASS
anon.deterministic	Pseudonymization is deterministic	PASS
anon.deleted_passthrough	“[deleted]” is preserved, not hashed	PASS
anon.reversible_by_dictionary	Hashing a known username recovers its pseudonym in the exemplar	PASS

Table S2b. Messages Thresh shows for each malformed paste (verbatim from `reddit.js`).

Paste	Message shown to the researcher
html	That looks like a web page (HTML), not data. Make sure the address bar ends in “.json”, then select all the text it shows and copy it.
truncated	The data looks cut off. Click into the Reddit tab, press Ctrl+A (Cmd+A on Mac) to select everything, copy, and paste again.
comments in posts box	That looks like a single post’s comments. For this step, open the listing link Thresh gave you (it ends in <code>/top.json</code> , <code>/hot.json</code> , <code>/new.json</code> , etc.).
private sub	Reddit returned an error: Forbidden. The subreddit may be private, quarantined, banned, or misspelled.

Table S2c. Pseudonym properties. Scheme: 32-bit unsalted Java-style string hash ($h = 31h + c$), $|h|$ in base 36, prefixed “user_”. Collision probability is the birthday bound for n distinct usernames in a 2^{31} output space.

n distinct usernames	1,000	10,000	100,000	1,000,000
$P(\geq 1 \text{ collision})$	0.0002	0.023	0.9025	1

Reversibility: hashing “AutoModerator” gives `user_wzj0fq`, which appears 100 times in the exemplar. Any username can be tested the same way; treat exports as pseudonymized, not anonymized.

S3 Frame dictionary and lexical statistics

Table S3a. Frames, their regular-expression stems (matched case-insensitively at word boundaries), and results over analyzable comments ($n = 4,764$).

Frame	Stems	Comments	Share (95% CI)	Mean VADER
Military operations	strikes? airstrikes? bomb\w* missiles? drones? troops carriers? military pentagon invasion ground war	439	9.2% (8.4%–10.1%)	−0.31
Nuclear program	nuclear nukes? enrich\w* uranium iaea	150	3.1% (2.7%–3.7%)	−0.28
War powers & Congress	congress\w* war powers authoriz\w* aumf constitution\w* unconstitutional impeach\w* declaration of war	210	4.4% (3.9%–5.0%)	−0.26
Partisan & leadership	trump\w* maga gop republicans? democrats? vance hegseth	1,279	26.9% (25.6%–28.1%)	−0.23
Economic costs	oil gas prices? gasoline inflation economy stock market markets? recession tariffs?	191	4.0% (3.5%–4.6%)	−0.25
Casualties & humanitarian	civilians? casualty\w* killed deaths? children humanitarian refugees? wounded	245	5.1% (4.5%–5.8%)	−0.53
Draft & service members	draft\w* conscription enlist\w* veterans? marines? soldiers? service members?	114	2.4% (2.0%–2.9%)	−0.38
Israel	israel\w* netanyahu idf zionis\w*	314	6.6% (5.9%–7.3%)	−0.26

Frame	Stems	Comments	Share (95% CI)	Mean VADER
Iranian regime & people	regime khamenei ayatollah irgc mullahs? iranian people regime change	94	2.0% (1.6%–2.4%)	–0.28
Diplomacy & ceasefire	diplomac\w* negotiat\w* ceasefire peace sanctions? jcpoa treaty	127	2.7% (2.3%–3.2%)	–0.03
Information integrity	propaganda bots? misinformation disinformation psyops? shills? astroturf\w* state media	38	0.8% (0.6%–1.1%)	–0.37

Table S3b. Most frequent terms (stop-words removed) in post titles and in analyzable comments.

Rank	Title term	n	Comment term	n
1	iran	103	trump	1,152
2	war	66	war	987
3	trump	60	iran	664
4	hegseth	9	israel	301
5	strikes	8	military	243
6	donald	7	president	227
7	americans	5	world	212
8	experts	5	country	211
9	official	5	epstein	200
10	nuclear	5	american	195
11	democrats	5	fucking	180
12	team	4	administration	169
13	epstein	4	oil	161
14	school	4	maga	159
15	briefing	4	shit	159
16	told	4	money	155
17	israel	4	fuck	147
18	coverage	4	republicans	145
19	senator	3	years	142
20	die	3	america	141

S4 Collection audit, headlines, and reproducibility record

Table S4a. Provenance claims checked against the exported bytes.

Item	Provenance says	Data show
Posts	100	100 (match)
Comments	4,956	4,956 (match)
Keyword	“Iran”	in 100% of titles
Duplicate / orphan IDs	—	0 post, 0 comment duplicates; 0 orphans
Comment depth	limited to 2 levels	depth 0: 2,540; depth 1: 2,416
Deleted/removed content	excluded	37 removed and 55 deleted bodies, 121 deleted authors present — the v1 note overstates exclusion

Item	Provenance says	Data show
Time window	month before 2026-03-20	2026-02-21 to 2026-03-20 (oldest post 27.3 days old)
Thread coverage	—	5.7% of 86,564 reported comments; 46–50 per thread

Table S4b. The ten highest-scoring posts. Titles are the linked outlets’ headlines as posted; they are reproduced as published news titles, not user speech.

Date (UTC)	Score	Ratio	Comments	Outlet	Headline
2026-03-05	36,098	0.95	2,046	lgbtqnation.com	GOP senator allegedly breaks Marine’s hand during protest against Iran war
2026-03-02	33,342	0.96	876	newsweek.com	Draft Barron Trump website launches as US strikes Iran
2026-03-05	33,253	0.96	2,312	people.com	Trump Says 'I Guess' Americans Should Worry About Iran Retaliating on U.S. Soil: 'Like I Said, Some People Will Die'
2026-03-16	32,458	0.96	2,494	huffpost.com	Donald Trump Stuns With 'Maybe We Shouldn't Even Be There' Admission About Iran War
2026-02-28	30,427	0.92	2,274	thedailybeast.com	MAGA Melts Down Over Iran War No One Voted For
2026-03-03	29,336	0.97	1,015	newrepublic.com	Kash Patel Fired Entire Team of Iran Experts Right Before Trump’s War
2026-03-17	29,082	0.98	800	telegraph.co.uk	Half of Americans believe Trump bombed Iran because of Epstein files
2026-03-12	26,685	0.91	3,992	newrepublic.com	John Fetterman Says Iran Girls’ School Strike Is Just a Leftist Craze
2026-03-03	26,031	0.95	2,722	newrepublic.com	Military Leaders Say Iran War Is So Trump Can Bring About “Armageddon”
2026-03-17	25,246	0.98	799	bbc.co.uk	Top US counterterrorism official resigns over Iran war

Table S4c. Reproducibility record.

Item	Value
SHA-256 posts.csv	07b5c1427bc2c89284dc5daca5a81cf52b9cd1db679d5172c95ed35328672c6a
SHA-256 comments.csv	de5fcf0c71c179523af2cb584e985054349cd07d9856f44d4cb0cf361f32c9c0
SHA-256 provenance.txt	08002464dea8c06a6287779e95b3c24a14fefec952d13a0a68ebfaecdd913537
Software	python 3.11.15 · pandas 3.0.6 · numpy 2.4.6 · scipy 1.17.1 · matplotlib 3.11.2 · vaderSentiment 3.3.2
Random seed / bootstrap	20260320 / 2,000 resamples
Statistics generated (UTC)	2026-09-29T17:30:31+00:00